

ELEVATE 215

Elevate 215 invests in Philadelphia schools that are already beating the odds, and helps more schools get there.

Serves public, charter, and private K–8 schools across Philadelphia — 16,600+ students in its current portfolio.

Funder Reporting Workflow

CONTEXT

16,600+

students in Elevate 215's
current portfolio

“Every claim in this deck traces back to something Stacy said directly — not an assumption.”

35 K–8 schools · 93% of revenue comes from contributions and grants.

Three conversations ground this proposal.

01 Trace

Traced the funder report workflow.

02 Find

Found the missing checkpoint.

03 Test

Tested this proposal with Stacy directly.

Beat the Odds funds schools that outperform what their demographics predict. Dr. Stacy Holland gives final sign-off on funding decisions.

MISTAKES HAVE NO CHECKPOINT.

TIME

Funder Reporting

“Three people, one week, every time a funder asks.”

FINANCIAL RISK

Monthly Board Deck

“A stale number reached the board before — and got caught live.”

MISSION

Beat the Odds Data

“Funding decisions run on one year of test scores.”

“Nobody's built a way to catch mistakes before they matter.”

— Stacy Holland, Executive Director

RECOMMENDATION

Start with funder reporting.

The workflow is scoped and repeatable.

STATUS	WORKFLOW	WHY
SCOPED	Funder Reporting	Answering what a funder’s money did at a school – currently three people, one week, every time.
NOT NOW	Monthly Board Deck	Three different problems, three different kinds of risk. Equally serious, but not first.
NOT NOW	Beat the Odds Data	“Don't come back and tell me something's feasible if you haven't actually looked.”

The report follows six manual steps.

01 Trigger A funder asks what its money did at a school, 8–10 times a year, especially in fall.	02 Renée’s notes Pull visit notes and metric status from one running document per school.	03 Grant agreement Track down what was promised, often in a shared drive, email, or Development.
04 QuickBooks Get clean payment records from Priya.	05 Assemble Build a custom Word doc, email table, or spreadsheet for that funder.	06 Send Stacy sends it without a second look.

FRICTION: The report is reconstructed every time. Most of the week is waiting on Renée and Priya.

The real cost is waiting, rework, and missed context

8–10X/YEAR

FUNDER REQUESTS

Heavier in fall.

UP TO 10–14 DAYS

TURNAROUND

One interview traced the same three-source process with quarterly and mid-year requirements.

0 REVIEWS

SECOND LOOKS

No second look before the report reaches the funder.

Fall and winter are harder because Renée and Marcus are less synced, so Stacy rebuilds context from scratch.

Add two checkpoints. Keep the rest intact.

01 Trigger A funder asks what its money did at a school.	02 Renée · NEW Adds a metric and on/off-track status beside each visit narrative.	03 Grant agreement Track down what was promised.
04 Stacy · NEW Queries the information instead of reading every note.	05 QuickBooks Get clean payment records from Priya.	06 Priya · NEW Reviews the report before it goes out.

Same as today: The trigger, grant agreement, QuickBooks records, and visit work stay in place.

| “Two things are added — nothing is replaced.”

Still open: where the tag lives, who reads it, how the query works, and when Priya reviews.

WHAT CHANGES

Elevate 215 gets visibility and accuracy back.

OUTCOME	EVIDENCE	MEASURE
VISIBILITY	Renée’s notes become something you can ask a question of — not something you read one visit at a time.	An answer in minutes instead of a week of reading.
ACCURACY	A second person checks the report before it reaches a funder — today, no one does.	Currently 0 of 8–10 yearly reports get a second look before sending.

NEXT

Close the open questions, then build.



Confirm

By Monday, September 28: confirm the tag, query, review timing, and grants-system questions with Renée, Priya, Dev, and the team.



Define

Before building, define success: faster turnaround, less rework, or fewer funder follow-ups?



Revise

Revise the proposal based on what they say, not what we assumed.



Build

Once confirmed, build the two changes and check them against the agreed measure.

MOVE FORWARD BY OCTOBER 12, 2026

DECISION REQUESTED · SEPTEMBER 24, 2026